

Macro Group at the UofT

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What is modern macroeconomics?

- A broad field addressing questions about the **aggregate behavior** of the economy.
- Use of **structural, general equilibrium models** to evaluate aggregate consequences of economic phenomena.
- **Micro to macro and back**: microfoundations and micro data inform and discipline macro models. Macro trends and shocks impact individual, micro decisions.
- **Core features**: dynamic decisions under uncertainty, interaction between agents through markets, internal consistency of micro decisions and macro aggregates, general equilibrium effects.

Macro Group at the UofT: large, broad, and well-established

- Michelle Alexopoulos
- Murat Celik
- Jason Choi
- Margarida Duarte
- Sebastian Dyrda
- Fatih Guvenen
- Gueorgui Kambourov
- Burhan Kuruscu
- Angelo Melino
- Mark Rempel
- Diego Restuccia
- Joao Ritto
- Joseph Steinberg
- Ronald Wolthoff

Courses and Research Events

Second-year courses we offer:

- Quantitative Macro
- Monetary Theory
- Topics in Growth and Development
- Topics in Macroeconomic Theory
- International Macro Theory

Research and social events:

- Weekly brown bag lunches: **Mondays, 12-1pm:**
 - Low-stakes forum to get early feedback on your ideas.
 - Fun and entertaining to participate!
- Weekly macro seminars: **Thursdays, 11am-12:30pm**
 - External, high-profile speakers.
 - Students meet them for lunches.
- Occasional research conferences.
- Frequent informal meetings with students.

Former and Current Macro Students

Former students:

- Stephen Ayerst (IMF)
- Marijn Bolhuis (IMF)
- Chaoran Chen (National University of Singapore)
- Amina Enkhbold (Bank of Canada)
- Guangbin Hong (Chicago, MSU)
- Shahar Rotberg (Canada Mortgage and Housing Corporation)
- Baxter Robinson (Western)

Current students:

- Anubha Agarwal
- James Macek (Alberta)
- Duc M. Nguyen (Amherst College)
- Irisa Zhou
- Renato Zimmermann
- A lot of others ...

Path to Success as a Macro Student

- Invest **heavily** in tools:
 - **Coding (!)**: Pick a modern, versatile language with well-tested libraries.
 - **Macro theory**: Dynamic programming, equilibrium with heterogeneity, continuous-time tools.
 - **Data skills**: Empirical analysis, econometric techniques, and handling large datasets.
- Take all **second-year** macro courses.
- Get an **RA position** with a faculty member.
 - Learning by doing.
 - You see how the **sausage** is made.
- **Reach out** to faculty to discuss your ideas.
 - Frequent meetings. Do not disappear for months at a time.
 - Most of your ideas will be **trash**, but you only need **one good idea** for your JMP.
- Present at the brown bag lunch **frequently**.
 - We are in a story-telling business. To sell the story well, you have to practice.

Where to start with your own idea?

- Read the news, economic blogs, and policy papers. The real world is full of important, interesting, and hard **macro questions**.
- Check the latest **NBER Summer Institute** and other NBER conference websites.
- Attend seminars, especially **job market talks**.
- **Consult the literature**. Read literature reviews (e.g., *Journal of Economic Perspectives*) and handbooks.
- The research frontier is out there somewhere. **It is your job to find it**, not your advisor's!

My Research Interests: Macro Public Finance

1. **Dynamic Fiscal Policy** in Models with Heterogeneity:

- Optimal, dynamic fiscal policy in standard incomplete markets models that account for inequality and idiosyncratic risk: [Dyrda, Pedroni \(2023\)](#).
- Dynamic fiscal policy and climate (carbon taxes), focusing on the role of government debt in the transition to a net-zero economy: [Douenne, Dyrda, Hummel, Pedroni \(2025\)](#).

2. **Entrepreneurship and Business Taxation:**

- Taxation of multinational enterprises in modern economies, addressing globalization, intangible capital, and profit shifting: [Dyrda, Hong, Steinberg \(2023, 2024, 2025, 202X\)](#).
- Taxation of privately held businesses (pass-throughs), retirement accounts, and interactions with entrepreneurship dynamics: [Dyrda, Pugsley \(2022, 2024, 2025\)](#); [Dyrda, Robinson, Zimmermann \(2025\)](#).

3. **Aggregate Shocks** in Heterogeneous Agent Economies:

- Micro and macro labor supply elasticity in economies with endogenous living arrangements of young adults: [Dyrda, Kaplan, Ríos-Rull \(2024\)](#).